

In the Bleak Midwinter

- 1 In the bleak midwinter,
frosty wind made moan,
earth stood hard as iron,
water like a stone;
snow had fallen, snow on snow,
snow on snow,
in the bleak midwinter,
long ago.
- 2 Our God, heav'n cannot hold him,
nor earth sustain;
heav'n and earth shall flee away
when he comes to reign.
In the bleak midwinter
a stable place sufficed
the Lord God incarnate,
Jesus Christ.
- 3 Angels and archangels
may have gathered there,
cherubim and seraphim
thronged the air;
but his mother only,
in her maiden bliss,
worshiped the beloved
with a kiss.
- 4 What can I give him,
poor as I am?
If I were a shepherd,
I would bring a lamb;
if I were a wise man,
I would do my part;
yet what I can I give him:
give my heart.

Words: Christina Rossetti, 1872; alt.

Music: Gustav Holst, 1906; alt.

Tune: CRANHAM · Irregular · Scripture: Luke 2:7-8

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